INTERNATIONAL CYBERSECURITY AND DIGITAL FORENSICS ACADEMY

Q3 GRC Phishing Simulation

Social Engineering Assessment & Technical Troubleshooting Report

Student	Kefilwe Matake
Registration Number	c11_26_CGRCE_17575
Course	GRC103
System	GoPhish on Kali Linux

ASSESSMENT STATUS: PARTIALLY EXECUTED — TECHNICALLY INCONCLUSIVE

Executive summary

A controlled phishing simulation was configured using GoPhish and launched against one self-designated test mailbox, in line with the ICDFA lab scenario. The supplied dashboard evidence records one email sent, with zero opens, zero link clicks, zero submitted data and zero reports. The test email was received, but clicking its link produced a browser message that the site could not be reached. The campaign therefore confirms email delivery, but it does not provide a valid measurement of user susceptibility or credential-submission behaviour. The most likely issue is that the landing-page URL points to a Kali Linux address that is not reachable from the device/browser used to open the email, or that the GoPhish phishing listener is not listening on the expected interface/port. This must be corrected and the controlled test repeated before drawing conclusions about human risk.

Evidence snapshot

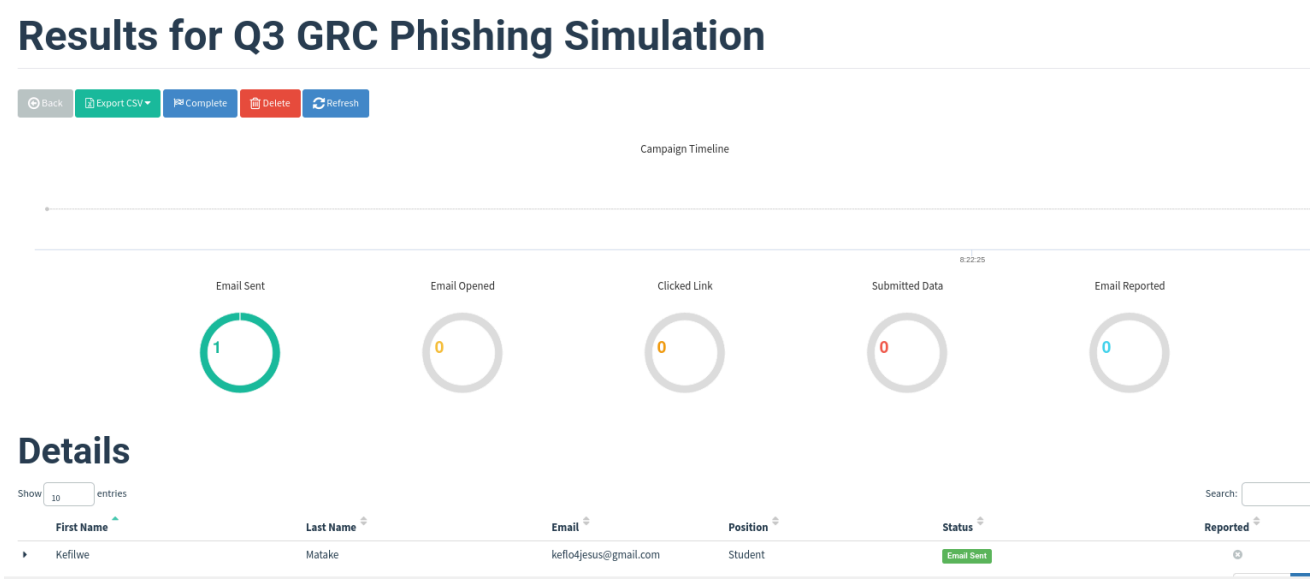


Figure 1. GoPhish dashboard supplied for the Q3 GRC Phishing Simulation.

Campaign metrics

Metric	Observed	Observed rate	Assessment / control implication
Emails sent	1 of 1	100%	Delivery confirmed for the single test recipient.
Emails opened	0 of 1	0% recorded	No open event recorded; not proof the message was not viewed.
Links clicked	0 of 1	0% recorded	Inconclusive: reported landing-page connectivity failure prevents valid susceptibility assessment.
Data submitted	0 of 1	0% recorded	Inconclusive: landing page could not be reached; credential-submission control not tested.
Emails reported	0 of 1	0% recorded	No report event recorded; sample is too small for a reporting-culture conclusion.

Interpretation: 0% is the observed dashboard rate, not a validated measure of user resistance. The reported page-access failure makes the click and submission outcomes inconclusive.

1. Introduction and purpose

This report documents a controlled, benign phishing simulation performed for the ICDFA GRC lab. The exercise examines the human element of information security and demonstrates how a GRC professional can use campaign evidence to assess awareness controls, identify technical limitations, and communicate risk to management.

The lab brief specifies a simulated target group, GoPhish as the phishing framework, a test mailbox, a hosted landing page, and analysis of email opens, link clicks and submitted data. The objective is measurement and control evaluation—not the collection of real credentials.

2. Scope, authorization and test boundaries

Scope: one self-designated test recipient; one Q3 GRC Phishing Simulation campaign; GoPhish hosted on Kali Linux; a simulated landing page; and the campaign dashboard supplied as evidence.

The evidence supplied does not establish the Kali IP address, network adapter mode, listener port, GoPhish configuration, or the device/network from which the link was opened. These details are therefore not assumed in this report.

Safety boundary: repeat testing only with accounts and devices under the learner's control or with explicit authorization. Use dummy data only. Do not collect, store or reuse real passwords.

3. Lab execution and observed outcome

The campaign dashboard is titled “Results for Q3 GRC Phishing Simulation”. The recipient row shows one test recipient (Kefilwe Matake), position “Student”, and status “Email Sent”. The dashboard counters show Email Sent = 1, Email Opened = 0, Clicked Link = 0, Submitted Data = 0 and Email Reported = 0.

The learner separately reports that the email was received and that clicking the link displayed a browser error indicating that the site could not be reached. This user-observed error is consistent with a landing-page reachability or listener configuration problem; it is not evidence that the recipient rejected the lure.

4. Campaign metrics and risk assessment

Rates below use the one email recorded as sent as the denominator. With a sample size of one, each event changes the rate by 100 percentage points. These are descriptive lab results, not statistically representative organizational rates.

Risk area	Current status	Risk rating	Required action
Email delivery	Working in this test	Low technical concern	Retain sending-profile evidence; ensure test authorization.
Landing-page availability	Failed / not reachable	High test-integrity concern	Validate listener, IP, port, firewall and network routing.
Human susceptibility	Not measured	Undetermined	Repeat the simulation after the page is reachable.
Credential exposure	Not measured	Undetermined	Use dummy data only; assess MFA and authentication protections separately.
User reporting	No report event	Undetermined	Validate reporting workflow and repeat with a sufficient authorized sample.

7. Risk interpretation and control assessment

Email delivery: successful for the single test recipient. This indicates that the sending profile and mail delivery path worked sufficiently to deliver the message.

Email opening: not recorded. This does not prove that the email was not viewed; open tracking may depend on remote image loading and can be affected by mail-client privacy protections.

Link clicking: not recorded. Because the recipient reports a site-unreachable error, the click event cannot be treated as a valid measure of user behaviour without confirming that the campaign link was correctly generated and the landing page was reachable.

Data submission: not recorded. This is not evidence that credential-handling controls prevented submission; the user could not reach the page. The lab brief's credential-submission metric is therefore not testable from the current evidence.

Email reporting: zero reports recorded. With one recipient and no confirmed interaction, no conclusion about reporting culture or the effectiveness of the reporting process can be made.

9. Conclusion

The exercise successfully demonstrated email delivery through GoPhish, but the landing-page access failure prevented a complete end-to-end phishing simulation. The current dashboard is insufficient to calculate meaningful susceptibility or credential-submission risk. The correct audit conclusion is that the campaign is partially executed and technically inconclusive—not that users are resistant to phishing. Once connectivity is fixed, the test should be repeated and the resulting metrics reassessed.

10. Answers to the lab's key questions and deliverables

What is the main purpose of the simulation? To measure susceptibility to a controlled phishing lure and evaluate the effectiveness of awareness, reporting and technical controls.

What do the current results show? One email was sent; no opens, clicks, submissions or reports were recorded in the dashboard. The recipient received the email but could not reach the landing page.

Can a click-through or credential-submission risk rate be concluded? No. The current recorded rates are 0%, but the connectivity failure makes them unsuitable for concluding that the user resisted the lure.

What is the likely technical issue? The Kali IP may not be reachable from the recipient device, or the phishing listener may not be listening on the correct interface/port. The exact cause requires the checks in Section 6.

What should management do? Validate the technical setup, repeat the simulation, maintain MFA, provide continuous awareness training, improve reporting and govern the testing process.

Deliverables: the supplied dashboard screenshot is included as evidence in this report; the risk assessment table and executive recommendations are provided below. A second screenshot showing a successfully loaded landing page and recorded click should be added after the retest.